AGENT MEMORY

Agent memory needs an audit trail before it needs a standard

Copilot forgets after 28 unused days. Other tools never forget.

7 slides - save for your next agent design review

THE PROBLEM

9+ memory formats. None can read the others.

Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Letta, Mem0, LangGraph, Graphiti/Zep and MCP memory servers each store what an agent learned their own way.

THE PROPOSAL

Mads Thines (LoreKit) drafts a shared memory format

1. **Record:** Markdown file with YAML frontmatter
2. **5 operations:** write, read, list, search, archive
3. **Tests:** round-trips, expiry, superseded records
4. **Out of scope:** storage, ranking, embeddings, UI

WHERE THE ANALOGY BREAKS

OpenTelemetry standardised a shape that already existed

TRACING IN 2019: Already converged

Every tool used spans with parent IDs before the merge.

AGENT MEMORY TODAY: Not converged

Tools disagree even on expiry: 28 days or forever.

WHY ACT NOW ANYWAY

Shared memory is a prompt-injection risk

Whoever can write a memory can plant an instruction that agents later read.

You need to know who wrote it.

WHAT I WOULD STANDARDISE FIRST

The audit trail, not the content

1. **Who:** which agent or person wrote the record
2. **When:** the time it was written
3. **Replaces:** the record it supersedes
4. **Signed:** how the writer proved it

Leave the content format until the field settles.

Which audit field would you ship first?